



Victorious: MI New York celebrates after winning the Cognizant Major League Cricket season 3. SPORTZPICS / MLC

the Major League will include the ability for the players to represent the USA National teams, subject to the players' selection for such representation."

But USA Cricket has objected to ACE's position that "the entirety of a salary paid to an MLC player can or should be offset against ACE's obligations under the Term Sheet" and has accused ACE of "essentially using USA Cricket to fund its MLC player salaries".

Viewed from an Indian or IPL context, ACE's argument would essentially mean Indian Test captain Shubman Gill's annual BCCI central contract of Rs. 5 crore and his match fees should be offset against his Gujarat Titans IPL salary of Rs. 16.5 crore.

No High-Performance Centre?: Though promised by 2020, ACE maintains that the Grand Prairie venue currently serves that role. However, sources within USA Cricket say that the stadium does not meet

the definition or minimum infrastructure standards of a fully operational High-Performance Centre, and that it was not developed in genuine consultation with USA Cricket, despite claims to the contrary.

No Minor League Cricket in 2025: The term sheet allows ACE to run Minor League Cricket but does not mandate it annually. So far, the League has seen four seasons since 2021. And while USA Cricket acknowledges that the Term Sheet includes the launch of MiLC, "it feels the spirit and intent of the agreement clearly require the sustainable and continuous operation of developmental competitions."

While there is no documentation available with this publication to support USA Cricket's claims that ACE meddled in athlete elections or team selection, USA Cricket insists that "the application of ACE's "good faith discretion" under the Term Sheet is being misused to influence national team selections, specifically by promoting the inclusion of MLC-contracted players who meet

only the minimum ICC domicile criteria."

USA Cricket's own finances: A house built on sand

The financial squeeze behind the confrontation is visible on the balance sheet. USA Cricket ended 2023 with just \$52,533 in cash against \$615,110 in current liabilities. Receivables swelled to \$505,689, and disclosures show \$439,000 of that tied to ACE. When the governing body's short-term survival depends on collecting from the same private partner it accuses of breach, leverage runs one way. The audit also reports continuing negative operating cash flow, reinforcing how quickly funding gaps can become existential.

"...the organisation had a net asset deficiency, negative cash flows from operating activities, and total current liabilities exceeding total current assets. The ability... to continue as a going concern is dependent upon management's plan," the USA Cricket auditors noted.

The note further stated that USA Cricket's ability to operate depends